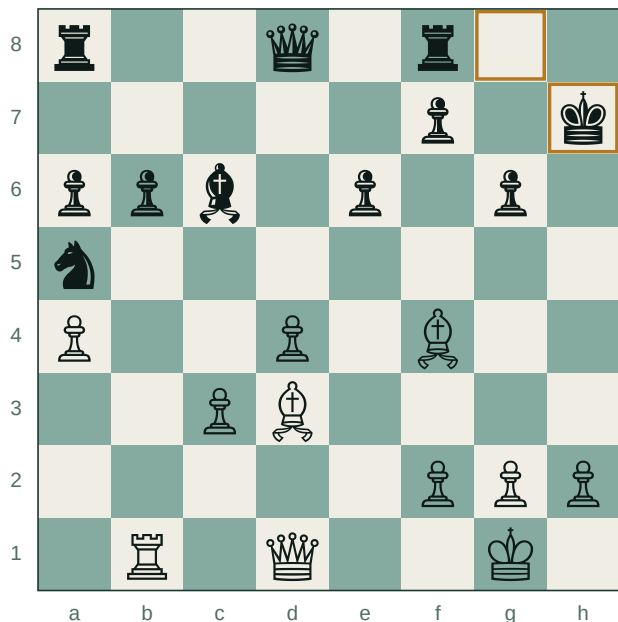


Deflection tactics: White, move 20

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 19...Kxh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Qh5+ Kg8 21. Bxg6 fxg6 22. Qxg6+

20.Qh5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From h5 it attacks king on h7 and knight on a5. Recorded reply: **20...Kg8**.

21.Bxg6 The bishop captures the pawn on g6. Recorded reply: **21...fxg6**.

22.Qxg6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -4 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.